Women at IISER Kolkata compared with other IISERs, IISc, Institutes of National Importance (INIs) and India

Sources: NIRF "Overall" submissions 2019 to 2026 (IISERs, IISc); AISHE 2023-24 (INIs, India). Gender is recorded as male or female only.

Where Kolkata stands

- **Students.** Women are **27.2%** of BS-MS undergraduates (286 of 1,050; 2024-25; 95% interval 24.6 to 30.0%). That is the lowest of the seven IISERs (Pune 27.6%, TVM and Tirupati about 52%), 13 points below the seven IISERs pooled (40.4%), about the same as the INI average (26.5%) and 22 points below India (49.5%). IISc's four-year UG is lower still (16.9%).
- **Faculty.** Women are **14.4%** of regular faculty (18 of 125; 2026; interval 9.3 to 21.6%), unchanged within 13.8 to 14.4% in every list since 2019. The seven IISERs pooled are 18.8%, INIs 22.1%, India 44.9%. Only Berhampur (12.0%) and IISc (10.0%) are lower. Reaching the INI average at today's size would need 10 more women; reaching the national average, 38 more.
- **Postgraduate.** Women are 33.1% of Kolkata's master's-level students (46 of 139), second lowest of five IISERs with data (Pune 39.7%, Tirupati 43.9%, TVM 51.2%; Bhopal 31.3%).

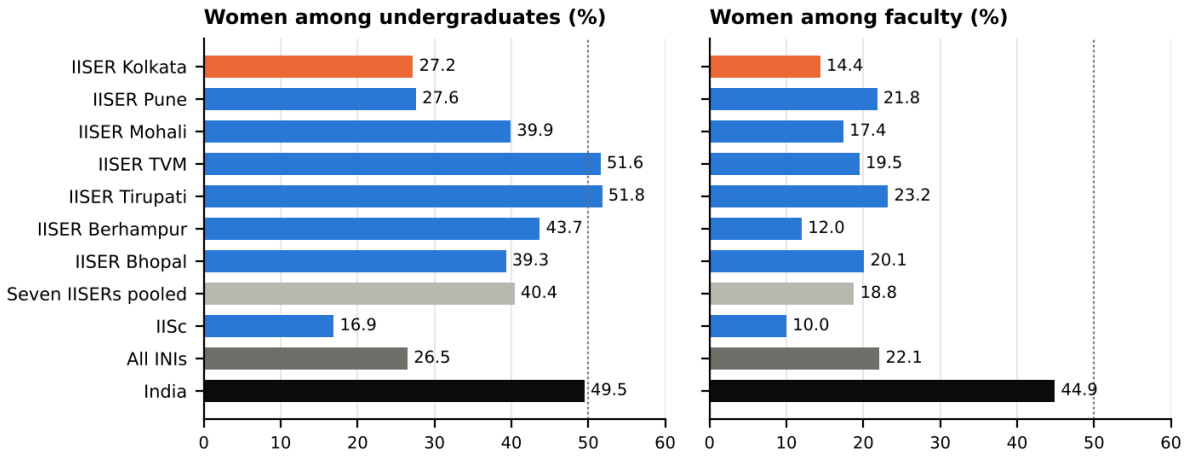


Figure 1. Women's share among undergraduates and among faculty. Orange: IISER Kolkata; blue: other IISERs; grey: IISERs pooled and all INIs; black: India. Dotted line: 50%. IISER years differ slightly (2023-24 to 2026) and IISc faculty is for 2026.

Why INIs sit below the national average

2023-24, women %	All INIs	India	Gap (points)
Undergraduates	26.5	49.5	−23.0
Postgraduates	30.9	55.7	−24.8
PhD students	34.6	50.1	−15.5
Faculty	22.1	44.9	−22.8

- **The gap is large at every stage**: women's share in INIs is about half the national share for undergraduates and faculty and about two-thirds for PhD students, where the gap is smallest.
- **Part of it is what INIs teach.** INIs are dominated by engineering and technology, where women are 31.1% of undergraduates nationally, while the national average is lifted by arts (53.9%), education (64.2%), medical science (57.4%) and science (53.4%). Nationally, state and private universities and their colleges (41 to 54% women teachers) also carry most of the faculty, while central universities (27.8%) look like INIs.
- **Mix probably does not explain all of it.** INI undergraduate share (26.5%) is below even the national engineering figure (31.1%). Without institute-level and discipline-level data we cannot say how much is mix and how much is admissions, retention or hiring.
- **What this means for us.** The INI average is a fairer comparison for IISER Kolkata than the national one, but it is a low bar, not a target. Kolkata's students match it; its faculty share (14.4%) is below it, with an interval (9.3 to 21.6%) lying wholly below 22.1%.

Limits: shares are for one year each and the numbers at the smaller IISERs are small, so differences of a few points should not be over-read. AISHE student shares by institution type are for all courses reported for that type. The INI group includes IITs, NITs, AIIMS and IISERs, so it is not a benchmark for basic-science institutes specifically. These data cannot show why shares differ.